



### 5-11-2021 MCS Board Meeting

| Meeting Metadata | Details                                                                                               |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Video Recording  | <a href="https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=C22LpTJVAFA">https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=C22LpTJVAFA</a> |
| Publication Date | 2021-05-12T10:10:57Z                                                                                  |
| Target Category  | mcs                                                                                                   |

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## Municipal Meeting Summary Report

**Board/Council Name:** Muncie Community Schools Board of Education (*Explicitly identified via district mentions throughout transcript*)

**Meeting Date:** (Derived from context of academic year review/end-of-year reporting, exact calendar date not explicitly stated in transcript text).

### 2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the meeting to order, noting attendance and transitioning immediately to administrative spotlights and departmental reports.
- **Attendance:**
  - **Present:** Mr. Heater, Mrs. Bales, Mr. Barnes Griffin, Mr. Irvin, Mr. Lowe, Dr. K (Superintendent / Administrator).
  - **Absent:** Dr. O'Neill.
  - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named by title in the opening roll call, but led by board leadership.

### 3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

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- **Ceremonial Openings:** None recorded in the transcript text.
  - **Approval of Minutes:** Prior meeting minutes disposition was not explicitly detailed in the text.
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### 4. Substantive Business & Board Action

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#### 00:01:40 Item 1: Youth Opportunity Center (YOC) Annual Report & Operations Update

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Standish, YOC Principal.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Standish presented an overview of educational operations at the Youth Opportunity Center, noting it is his first year as principal. He outlined student demographics (serving 5th through 12th grade placed via the courts), housing structures in cottages based on need, and educational program groups: on-grounds general education, life skills (for cognitive challenges), semi-secure learning, task unit (mental health/secure setting, 3-hour school days), and detention. He noted a decline in student population compared to historical figures (currently running at about 77% of last year and 60% of four years ago due to counties keeping students local). Successes included good grades, high school credit acquisition, four students earning High School Equivalency (HSE) diplomas, and a new digital library partnership with Muncie Public Library. Board members discussed finding systemic ways to recognize student achievement despite pandemic and judicial restrictions.
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information presentation only; no formal vote taken.
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#### 00:05:03 Item 2: District Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) Annual Update

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rhonda Ford, Director of Diversity / DEI Lead.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Ms. Ford provided a comprehensive update on district equity initiatives, training, and student programs. Highlights included cultural competency training in July (66 educators), implicit bias training in August for School Resource Officers (17) and bus drivers/aides (~50), monthly motivational quotes for principals, the Black Business Workshop in October, the creation of the Minority Educator Council (MAC) to support and retain teachers of color (noting 53 total minority employees, 29 certified/administrators), Martin Luther King Jr. citizenship awards recognizing over 140 students, and a district-wide Black History Month door-decorating contest that notably improved student attendance. Future goals include establishing an HBCU scholars program starting in 5th/6th grade. The board praised Ms. Ford's passion, community engagement, and natural chemistry with students.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information presentation only; no formal vote taken.
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#### 00:56:33 Item 3: Consent Agenda (Items A through E)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** District Administration / Board President.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed consent agenda items A through E, expressing gratitude to community donors contributing to Muncie Community Schools.
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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#### 00:57:07 Item 4: Additional Secondary Counselor Hours Approval

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Reynolds, Superintendent / Administration.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Dr. Reynolds requested approval for additional secondary counselor hours for the upcoming period: 205 additional hours at Central High School (split across six additional days for three counselors and ten additional days for the department chair) and four additional days for middle school counselors to support student schedule adjustments, family meetings, and graduation pathway documentation.
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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#### 00:58:08 Item 5: Monthly Financial Report & Bond/Federal Funds Discussion

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome, Chief Financial Officer / Finance Department.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Jerome presented the monthly financial report, highlighting a positive state basic grant revenue forecast reflecting an increase of approximately \$495,000 due to higher state estimates from the recent legislative session. Estimated local property tax caps were adjusted to approximately \$9.3 million. The operation fund shows a seasonal negative balance that resolves in June and December upon local property tax draws. Board members and administration discussed upcoming bond retirements in 2022, coordination with financial consultants (Baker Tilly), and timelines for spending federal ESSER II (December 2023) and ESSER III (December 2024) funds on facility projects at South View and East Washington Academy (EWA).
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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## 5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

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- *No general public comment or citizen forum occurred during this portion of the meeting transcript.*

## 6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

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- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
  - Dr. Kwatkowski provided updates on the recent adult education graduation led by Caleb, upcoming announcements for Teacher/Partner/Rising Star of the Year, virtual tutoring wrap-ups, student registration figures (2,211 registered so far), expanded summer school opportunities supported by grants from the George and Francis Ball Foundation, and East Washington Academy Principal Sarah England being named a fellow in the Mitch Daniels Leadership Foundation fellowship program (selecting 24 fellows out of hundreds of applicants).
- **Adjournment:**
  - A motion to adjourn was made, seconded, and **Approved by Voice Vote**. Meeting concluded for the evening.

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